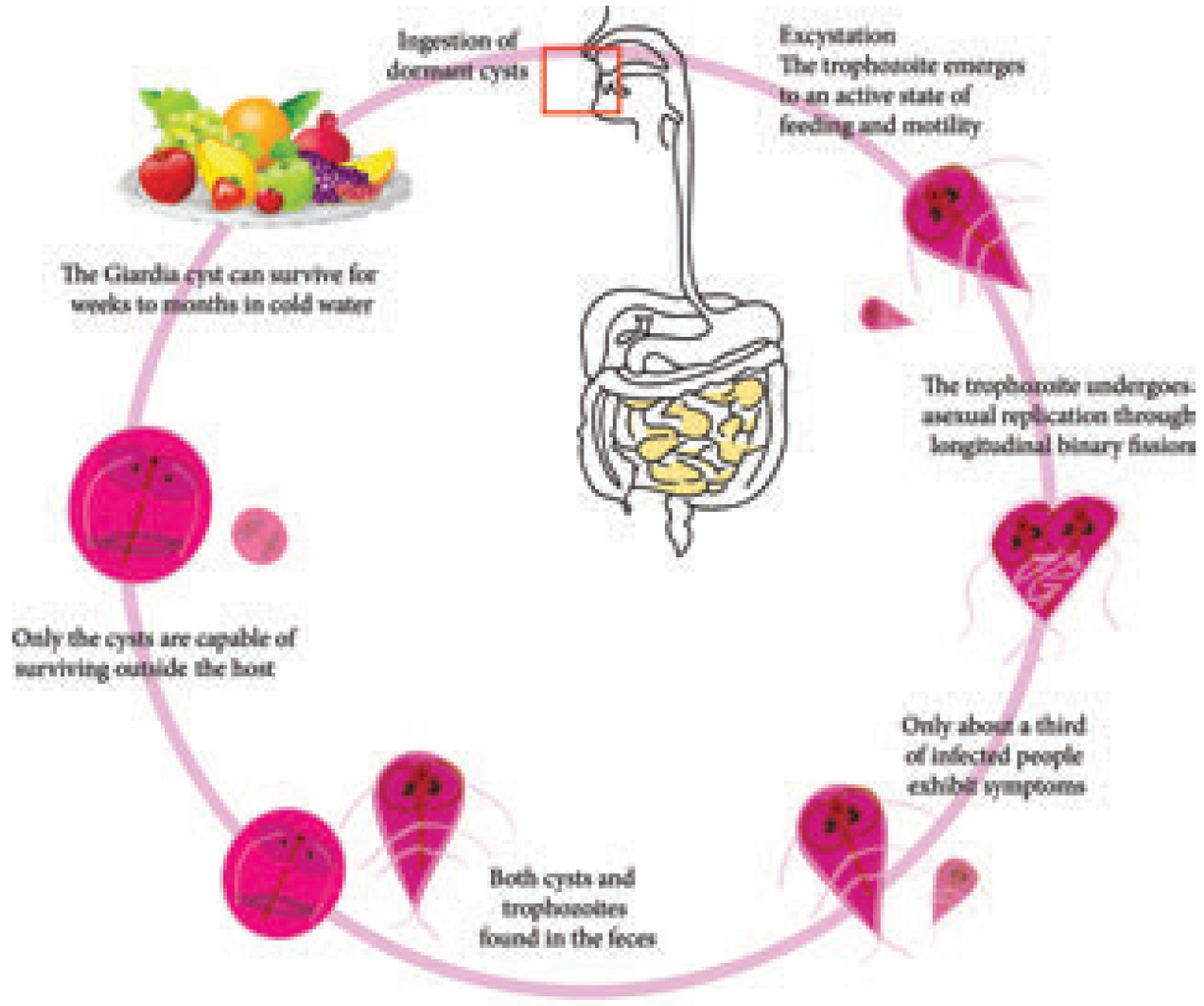


Figure 8.7: Life cycle of *Giardia lamblia*

The disease is asymptomatic, but in some cases it may lead to abdominal cramps, flatulence, looseness of bowels, foul smelling stool and mild steatorrhoea (passage of yellowish and greasy stools in which there is excess of fat). The stool contains excess mucus and fat but no blood and pus. Children may develop chronic diarrhoea, malaise (discomfort), nausea, anorexia (loss of appetite for food), malabsorption of fat, vitamin A and protein. Occasionally, Giardia may colonize the gall bladder causing biliary colic and jaundice.

8.3.7 Laboratory Diagnosis

Specimens: Stool and blood

Examination of stool sample: Giardiasis can be diagnosed by identification of cysts of *Giardia lamblia* in the formed stools and the trophozoites and cyst of the parasite in diarrhoeal stools.

Macroscopic examination of stool: Fecal specimens containing *Giardia lamblia* may have an offensive odor. It is pale coloured with fatty substance floating in water.

Microscopic examination of stool: Cysts and trophozoites can be found in

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